The March of the Flag

Albert J. Beveridge · September 16, 1898

Source: Albert J. Beveridge, "The March of the Flag" (1898). Public domain. Continuous passage.

> An Indiana Senate candidate's rousing case for American imperialism after the Spanish-American War: annex the Philippines, Hawaii, and Puerto Rico as a God-given duty — and set aside "consent of the governed" for peoples he deemed unready.

It is a noble land that God has given us; a land that can feed and clothe the world; a land whose coastlines would inclose half the countries of Europe; a land set like a sentinel between the two imperial oceans of the globe, a greater England with a nobler destiny.

[. . .]

The Opposition tells us that we ought not to govern a people without their consent. I answer, The rule of liberty that all just government derives its authority from the consent of the governed, applies only to those who are capable of self-government. We govern the Indians without their consent, we govern our territories without their consent, we govern our children without their consent.